MOHAMMAD MEHDI PAKRAVAN

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EDUCATION

Sharif University of Technology, Tehran, Iran *Sep 2022 – Mar 2025*
M.Sc. in Economics
Thesis: "Board Network Centrality and Financial Performance: Evidence from Listed Publishing Companies on the Tehran Stock Exchange"
Supervisor: Dr. Farshad Fatemi Ardestani
Relevant Coursework: Microeconomic Theory, Econometrics, Applied Econometrics, Industrial Organization, Corporate Finance

Isfahan University of Technology, Isfahan, Iran *Oct 2017 – Sep 2021*
B.Sc. in Electrical Engineering (Control)
Final Project: "Bitcoin Price Prediction Using LSTM Neural Networks" (Advisor: Dr. Maryam Zekri)
Relevant Coursework: Calculus, Linear Algebra, Probability and Statistics, Regression Analysis, Partial Differential Equations

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Empirical Industrial Organization, Network Economics, Corporate Governance, Applied Microeconometrics

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Master's Thesis: Board Network Centrality and Financial Performance: Evidence from Listed Publishing Companies on the Tehran Stock Exchange *Sep 2024 – Mar 2025*
Supervisor: Dr. Farshad Fatemi Ardestani, Sharif University of Technology

- Constructed an original director–firm bipartite network dataset covering 300+ listed firms and 2,000+ firm-year observations (2016–2024), using web scraping and manual verification.
- Calculated director-level degree, closeness, betweenness, and eigenvector centrality measures and constructed firm-level indicators of board network connectedness.
- Estimated dynamic panel-data models using System GMM to examine the relationship between board network connectedness and firm performance (Tobin's Q, ROA, and ROS), accounting for performance persistence and potential endogeneity.
- Found that director connections improve firm performance primarily in firms with dispersed ownership, with weaker effects in concentrated-ownership firms.
- Built the full pipeline (scraping, cleaning, network construction in Python; estimation in Stata), version-controlled on GitHub.

Research Assistant, Labor Market Analysis Project *Aug 2023 – Nov 2023*
Iran Parliament Research Center (IPRC), Tehran, Iran

- Analyzed Iranian household expenditure surveys and employment statistics to support evidence-based minimum wage policy recommendations.
- Applied Autoregressive Distributed Lag (ARDL) models to estimate sectoral minimum wages and analyse labour market dynamics.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Econometric Software	Stata (System GMM, panel data, fixed effects), R
Programming	Python, Julia, MATLAB
Data Management	SQL (MySQL), Web Scraping (Selenium, Playwright)
Other Tools	Git/GitHub, LaTeX, Microsoft Excel, Linux Shell

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Introductory Econometrics (Undergraduate) *Spring 2025*
Department of Economics, Sharif University of Technology

- Designed problem sets and coding assignments, developed grading rubrics, and held weekly office hours.
- Graded examinations and gave individualized feedback on students' empirical research projects.

HONORS & AWARDS

- Merit-Based Full Tuition Scholarship, Sharif University of Technology *Sep 2022 – Mar 2025*
- Ranked 22nd among approximately 5,000 candidates (Top 0.5%), Iranian National Graduate Entrance Examination in Economics *May 2022*
- Merit-Based Tuition Scholarship, Isfahan University of Technology *2017 – 2021*
- Ranked in the Top 2% in the Iranian National University Entrance Examination (Konkur), Mathematics and Physics Track *Jun 2017*

SERVICE & OUTREACH

Workshop Instructor, Game Theory for High School Students *2024 – Present*
Isfahan Mathematics House, Isfahan, Iran

- Design and deliver a 10-week introductory course on game theory and strategic decision-making.
- Develop interactive exercises illustrating applications of game theory in economics and social sciences.

ACADEMIC PROGRAMS & ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Development Economics Summer School, Sharif University of Technology *Dec 2022*
Two-week intensive program covering research methods and recent developments in development economics.

Online Coursework (Coursera)

- Applied Machine Learning in Python – Kevyn Collins-Thompson *Dec 2019*
- Neural Networks and Deep Learning – Andrew Ng *May 2020*
- Improving Deep Neural Networks: Hyperparameter Tuning and Regularization – Andrew Ng *Jun 2020*
- Structuring Machine Learning Projects – Andrew Ng *Oct 2020*

LANGUAGES

Persian (Native), English (Fluent)

REFERENCES

Dr. Farshad Fatemi Ardestani
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Sharif University of Technology
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Dr. Maryam Zekri
Associate Professor of Control Engineering
Isfahan University of Technology
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